

Think before you automate.

A structured RPA Business Analysis framework for scoping AS-IS processes and designing TO-BE automation blueprints.

PROCESS NAME / AUTOMATION CANDIDATE

Accounts Payable Invoice Processing

TIME BOX

15 MIN30 MIN1 HOUROPEN

SAVED BLUEPRINTS

Accounts Payable Invoice Processing (5/17/2026)▼

7/7

11

79%

9/10

PHASES OPENITEMS CHECKEDFIELDS FILLED

AVG CONFIDENCE

01

AS-IS Process Mapping

Map the current manual state and baseline metrics.

✓ FEASIBILITY GATE

Highly Rule-Based (No cognitive decisions required)

✓ FEASIBILITY GATE

Standardized & Readable Inputs (No handwritten text or fuzzy data)

✓ FEASIBILITY GATE

Stable UI / Mature Application Environment

WHAT IS THE CURRENT MANUAL PROCESS (STEP-BY-STEP)?

5. Post the transaction in SAP and copy the generated SAP invoice document ID.
6. Paste the SAP document ID into the shared Excel tracking log and mark as Posted.
7. Move the processed email to the 'Processed' archive folder.

WHAT APPLICATIONS AND SYSTEMS ARE TOUCHED?

Microsoft Outlook (Office 365), SAP GUI v7.6, Microsoft Excel (SharePoint Shared Document).

VOLUME & HANDLE TIME (THE METRICS)

Frequency: Monthly, Volume per cycle: 500 transactions, Average Handle Time: 15 min.
Estimated bandwidth freed: 1395 man-hours/year. Applications used: 2–3 applications. Process steps: 10–15 steps.

02

Business Value & ROI

Define the financial and operational justification for automating.

WHAT IS THE PRIMARY BUSINESS DRIVER?

Eliminate manual data entry effort for 3 FTEs, reduce transaction processing cycle time from 3 days to under 4 hours, and eliminate human copy-paste errors.

WHAT IS THE ACCEPTABLE ERROR RATE / BUSINESS EXCEPTION TOLERANCE?

Assessment reported 5% exception rate (cases where the process could not be completed).

SECONDARY BENEFITS

Ensure 100% compliance with corporate posting rules and establish a clean, detailed electronic audit trail for year-end audits.

DATA CONFIDENCE

9 / 10

03

Technical & Business Exceptions

Name the constraints so the bot doesn't fail in production.

DATA SENSITIVITY & COMPLIANCE

Handles corporate accounts payable data. Must strictly operate within VPN, and credentials/financial numbers must never be logged in plain text logs.

HARD TECHNICAL CONSTRAINTS

e.g. Application lacks an API, strict Infosec rules around passwords, UI changes frequently, requires Citrix automation...

KNOWN BUSINESS EXCEPTIONS

When MUST the bot stop and hand off to a human? e.g. 'If invoice amount > \$10k', 'If account is locked', 'If ID does not match records'...

OUT OF SCOPE (EXPLICIT BOUNDARIES)

Invoices exceeding EUR 10,000 or those requiring custom tax adjustments. These must be left for manual reviewer processing.

CONFIDENCE IN EXCEPTION MAPPING

9 / 10

04

Dependency Mapping

What has to be true before dev can start?

PREREQUISITES (ACCESS & INFRASTRUCTURE)

SAP Test Environment access, dedicated Windows Service Account, VPN access, robot email inbox, SharePoint Excel spreadsheet permission.

STAKEHOLDERS: PROCESS OWNER & SMES

Process Owner: Sarah Jenkins (VP Finance). SME: Dave Miller (Senior AP Accountant).

UPSTREAM CHANGES

No application UI or network updates scheduled for Outlook, SAP GUI, or SharePoint in the next six months.

05

The TO-BE Automated State

Sketch the architecture of the new automated process.

TRIGGER

Scheduled trigger every weekday morning at 6:00 AM.

THE HAPPY PATH

BOT DOWNLOADS UNREAD INVOICE E-MAILS FROM ACCOUNTS-PAYABLE MAILBOX, READS TEXT VIA STANDARD PDF PARSING LIBRARY, LOGS INTO SAP GUI FB60, ENTERS DATA, PERFORMS PO MATCH, POSTS, LOGS SAP ID ID TO EXCEL, MOVES EMAIL TO PROCESSED.

HUMAN-IN-THE-LOOP (HANDOFFS)

Any invoice with parsing confidence less than 90% or PO matching mismatch greater than 2% is queued in UiPath Action Center for Dave Miller to review and approve.

FINAL BOT OUTPUT & ARTIFACTS

Posted transaction in SAP, updated Excel row with SAP ID, summary email sent to AP Manager.

ARCHITECTURE CONFIDENCE

9 / 10

06

Edge Case Audit

Challenge the design before presenting it.

✓ INPUT DATA QUALITY

Is the input data 100% structured, or are we relying on fuzzy OCR/free-text?

✓ SYSTEM LATENCY

Have we accounted for slow load times in legacy applications?

✓ CREDENTIAL MANAGEMENT

Is there a secure way to store passwords (e.g. CyberArk, Orchestrator Assets)?

✓ SCALE CHECK

If volume 10x's tomorrow, does this architecture hold up?

THE WORST-CASE SCENARIO

If SAP GUI crashes mid-transaction, the bot terminates SAP processes, re-launches SAP, logs in, checks if the invoice number was already posted, and either continues or rolls back.

UNMAPPED / CUSTOM EDGE CASES

Year-end vendor invoices sometimes contain multiple tax categories. Bot will auto-flag these and forward to Dave Miller.

07

PDD Readiness Gate

Final QA check before developer handoff.

✓ AS-IS COMPLETE

Are all AS-IS steps documented with no "magic" missing steps?

✓ ROI QUANTIFIED

Is the business value explicitly clear to a non-technical stakeholder?

✓ EXCEPTIONS MAPPED

Are both Business and System Exceptions clearly defined?

✓ TRIGGER DEFINED

Is the bot schedule or trigger mechanism finalized?

THE PM MOVE

Next Action

Don't let the document stall. What specific thing should happen next to move this pipeline forward?

Schedule technical walkthrough with Dev Lead (Alex Rivera) on Tuesday morning for final architectural sign-off.

AI BA Lead Review

PROXY ACTIVE

EVALUATES PDD LOGIC · CALCULATES ROI · SCORES STAKEHOLDER VALUE

CUSTOM KEY

RE-REVIEW

AI

RPA Blueprint Review: Accounts Payable Invoice Processing

Phase 1: Feasibility Gate Evaluation

Status: PASSED with Caveat.

The blueprint explicitly checks all critical feasibility gates:

Highly Rule-Based (No cognitive decisions required): Checked.

Standardized & Readable Inputs (No handwritten text or fuzzy data): Checked.

Stable UI / Mature Application Environment: Checked.

Caveat: While "Standardized & Readable Inputs" is checked, the TO-BE section mentions "read text via standard PDF parsing library" and "parsing confidence less than 90% or PO matching mismatch greater than 2% is queued in UiPath Action Center". This implies a reliance on OCR/intelligent document processing (IDP) rather than purely structured data. While a robust solution with Human-in-the-Loop (HIL) for exceptions is a viable strategy, it's crucial to acknowledge that this moves beyond *purely* standardized and readable *fixed-format* inputs. The HIL for low confidence scores is a good mitigation, but the initial "Standardized & Readable Inputs" might be slightly optimistic if it implies fixed-field extraction without any OCR/IDP uncertainty. Ensure the selected PDF parsing library is suitable for the *actual* variability of vendor invoice formats.

Calculate ROI & ScoreFind Missing ExceptionsChallenge FeasibilityDraft Exec Summary

Ask the BA Lead a question...

